

SEDAR 54 Highly Migratory Species Sandbar Shark

We list below research recommendations that are more feasible and would allow substantial improvement of future stock assessment of this stock:

- Determine what is missing in terms of experimental design or/and data analysis to arrive at incontrovertible (to the extent that it may be scientifically possible) conclusions on the reproductive periodicity of the stock
- Continue work on reconstruction of historical catches, especially catches outside of the US EEZ
- Investigate the length composition of the F3 Recreational and Mexican fisheries more in depth as this fishery is estimated to have a large impact on the stock mainly due to selecting age-0 fish.
- Research to estimate the degree of connectivity between the portions of the stock within the US and outside of the US EEZ.
- Study the distribution and movements of the stock relative to sampling coverage. It is possible that none of the indices alone track stock-wide abundance trends.